Since all layers share a single schema and policy set, they can be audited collectively. Policy logs from the C³ PDP and tenant PDPs can be correlated by `policy_id` and `tenant_id`, resulting in a unified record of both platform and tenant decisions.

C³'s approach builds directly on the policy lifecycle practices introduced earlier, in Chapter 10, where ACME's engineers learned to author, validate, and test policies as code. The same principles—schema validation, version control, and automated testing—now extend across tenants and policy layers.

In the next chapter, we'll examine how this layered structure integrates into ACME's broader governance framework: how policies are distributed, normalized, and monitored in production; how context freshness and assurance are maintained; and how the platform balances flexibility with oversight at scale.

13.6 Case studies inside ACME

Once C³ moved into pilot deployments, ACME used several internal scenarios to test the two-layer authorization model in production. These case studies demonstrate how system, application, and tenant policies interact and show how externalized authorization simplifies what previously required custom code.

13.6.1 Case 1: Cross-tenant legal review

When ACME's legal department needs to audit documents across multiple customers, its employees operate outside of any single tenant boundary:

1. The request comes from an ACME employee using a compliance tool connected to C³'s API.
2. The PEP in the gateway verifies the employee's posture and identity before calling the C³ PDP.
3. A system policy grants access exclusively to members of the legal team using compliant devices.